

scripts/check-helix-deps-manifest.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-05-15 (constitution-compliance plan Phase 3) **Inheritance:** HelixConstitution §11.4.31 (Submodule-Dependency-Manifest Mandate) + §11.4.18 (script docs)

Overview

Verifies that the parent project root + every owned-by-us submodule ships a `helix-deps.yaml` (or `.json` / `.toml` variant — single canonical file per submodule) declaring its inter-submodule dependencies per HelixConstitution §11.4.31.

The manifest is what an incorporator script reads to bootstrap a fresh project's submodule graph from scratch — eliminating the §11.4.28-forbidden nested own-org submodule chains by making each dependency declaratively flat-layoutable.

Manifest schema (per §11.4.31)

```
schema_version: 1

deps:
  - name: <CanonicalName>
    ssh_url: git@github.com:<org>/<name>.git
    ref: main           # branch or pinned tag
    why: "<human-readable rationale>"
    layout: flat        # 'flat' = <root>/<name>; 'grouped' =
                        <root>/submodules/<name>/

transitive_handling:
  recursive: true
  conflict_resolution: operator-required

language_specific_subtree: false  # true = inner subtree exempt
                                from §11.4.29 snake_case
```

Validation passes per manifest

1. File exists at canonical path (`helix-deps.yaml` preferred; `.json` / `.toml` accepted)
2. `schema_version: 1` declared
3. `deps`: top-level array present

4. transitive_handling: block present

(Deeper schema validation — per-dep name/ssh_url/ref/why/layout field-level checks — is owed to a follow-up enhancement; current scanner uses a structural grep-based fallback that catches the most common drift class without requiring yq / python-yaml toolchain.)

Modes

Flag	Behavior
--strict (default)	Exit 1 on any violation
--advisory	Exit 0 even on violation
LAVA_HELIX_DEPS_STRICT=0 env	Same as --advisory

Usage

```
bash scripts/check-helix-deps-manifest.sh           # strict
              (default)
bash scripts/check-helix-deps-manifest.sh --advisory # exit 0
              even on violation
LAVA_HELIX_DEPS_STRICT=0 bash scripts/check-helix-deps-
manifest.sh    # env-driven
```

Hermetic test

tests/check-constitution/test_helix_deps_manifest.sh — 6 fixtures:

1. test_compliant_fixture_passes — parent + per-submodule manifests both present + well-formed
2. test_missing_parent_manifest_rejected — repo root lacks helix-deps.yaml
3. test_missing_submodule_manifest_rejected — owned submodule lacks helix-deps.yaml
4. test_wrong_schema_version_rejected — schema_version: 999 (must be 1)
5. test_advisory_mode_returns_zero — advisory swallows exit code
6. test_json_variant_accepted — discrimination test: helix-deps.json is recognized as a valid alternative extension

Known violations (2026-05-15 audit)

Parent manifest:  helix-deps.yaml (well-formed, declares 17 deps: 16 vasic-digital submodules + constitution).

Per-submodule manifests: 16 of 16 owned submodules MISSING helix-deps.yaml.

Submodule	Status
Auth, Cache, Challenges, Concurrency, Config, Containers, Database, Discovery, HTTP3, Mdns, Middleware, Observability, RateLimiter, Recovery, Security, Tracker-SDK	× MISSING — owed in per-submodule follow-up commits

Resolution path: per-submodule cycle (write helix-deps.yaml → commit to submodule → push to GitHub + GitLab per §6.W → bump pin in parent Lava). The parent commit can batch the 16 pin bumps once each submodule has its own manifest. Then sweep wrapper flips from advisory → strict.

Cross-references

- HelixConstitution Constitution.md §11.4.31 (the mandate)
- docs/plans/2026-05-15-constitution-compliance.md Phase 3
- docs/helix-constitution-gates.md CM-HELIX-DEPS-MANIFEST row
- scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh (wraps this scanner per §11.4.32)
- Lava parent's reference manifest: helix-deps.yaml (declares all 16 submodule deps + constitution)

2026-05-15 update — HelixQA waiver

Phase 4 of the constitution-compliance plan adopted submodules/helixqa (HelixDevelopment-owned QA orchestration framework) at upstream HEAD 403603db. HelixQA's CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / CONSTITUTION.md follow the canonical-root ## INHERITED FROM Helix Constitution pointer pattern (HelixDevelopment-authored) rather than Lava's heading-anchored §6.R / §6.S / §6.X / §6.AD pointer-block format. HelixQA also lacks helix-deps.yaml + install_upstreams.sh wrapper script.

Resolution: HELIX_DEV_OWNED=("HelixQA") waiver list + is_helix_dev_owned() helper skip HelixQA in every per-Submodule loop in this scanner. Waiver entries cite Phase 4-debt: PR to HelixDevelopment/HelixQA upstream owed to add the missing files. Once upstream merges + Lava's pin advances to include them, HelixQA can be removed from the waiver list.

2026-05-16 update — HelixQA waiver RESOLVED

The Phase 4-debt PR to HelixDevelopment/HelixQA upstream landed as commit b13ba7c (feat(gov): add helix-deps.yaml + install_upstreams.sh wrapper), adding both missing files at HelixQA's repo root. Lava's pin advanced to b13ba7c in the same parent commit that removed HelixQA from HELIX_DEPS_WAIVERS. The waiver list is now empty — the per-Submodule loop in this scanner treats HelixQA on equal terms with the other 16 owned submodules; all 17 must ship a parseable helix-deps.yaml at the submodule root or the scanner reports a violation. The HELIX_DEPS_WAIVERS=() empty array is intentionally retained as a forensic anchor.